

Reviewers' Guide: Training Guide

Training Goals:

1. The audience will understand that community feedback is necessary before publishing a Bible translation, because feedback can:
 - Improve quality by revealing places where the translation is not clear or accurate.
 - Increase community acceptance of the translated Scriptures.
2. The audience will be able to:
 - Use the **Reviewers' Guide** to lead a community review (demonstrated by Exercise).

Estimated Time: 60-90 minutes

Materials:

- ✓ **Slides: Reviewers' Guide Training - Slides OR a printed page of the **NT Survey RG** for Matthew 3:13-17 for guided practice**
- ✓ **Bible**
- ✓ **A portion of the **NT or OT Survey RG** for the Exercise (1 copy per 4 people)**
- ✓ **Source Text of the Scripture passage being reviewed (1 per 4 people)**
- ✓ **Printed Scripture in a translation to "review" (1 per person)**

Note: For the Exercise, a set of materials to practice a review in English is included at the end of this Walkthrough. **If you are training in a Gateway Language:** use the **NT Survey Reviewers' Guide** in your GL, if available. Print the pages for Matthew 13:44-46 and Romans 9:30-33. Print these Scripture passages in the Gateway Language text for each leader of a group of 4 people. Print the same passages in a different translation for each person to practice reviewing.

Introduction: Once a translation team has completed the translation of the New Testament using the Eight Steps Translation process, that team has taken great care to make the translation accurate and clear. The time has come for that team to seek the help of others in affirming the quality of the translation.



The **Reviewers' Guide** collects feedback from other mother-tongue believers about the translation. This step in Refinement helps translators determine if the translation clearly communicates the intended meaning. This module will train leaders to use the **Reviewers' Guide (RG)**.

Note: The **Reviewers' Guide** has several sections, such as:

- New Testament/Old Testament Survey
- Book Guides
- Divine Familial Terms Tables
- Doctrine Guides

The review process covered in this training is the same for the **Book**, **Doctrine**, and **Survey** sections of the **RG**. However, the ****New Testament (or Old Testament) Survey** is the only section that is required to be completed** before a community can receive publication assistance from Wycliffe Associates when publication funding is available. Because of this, all the practice in this module focuses on the **New Testament Survey**.

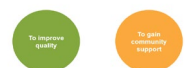
Ask: Why do you think it is important to ask for others to give input on the quality of the translation?

Write their ideas on the board.

Explain: Getting feedback from others is important for several reasons. These two are the most important:

1. Feedback helps improve the quality of the translation.
2. Asking for feedback also gains community support for the translation.

Why seek community feedback?



To conduct a review session, the translation team will need to choose a leader and seek other mother-tongue believers willing to help review the translation. There should be at least 2 reviewers, but not more than 4 reviewers, for each session.

Reviewers' Guide Training

Choosing a Review Leader: It is recommended for the translation team to choose their own team leader or another person on the team to conduct the review process.

- The leader for the review sessions should have some biblical background. This will help him or her to adjust questions and to clarify responses from the reviewers.
- The leader should also have a good reputation and demonstrate leadership skills.
- The leader should have a good relationship with the translation team, because he or she will need to share suggested changes with them after the review sessions.
- The leader needs to have strong bilingual skills. This is because the *RG* will only be available in the gateway language. The leader will also need to look at the gateway language Scripture to assess reviewers' answers.



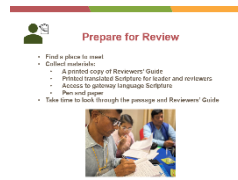
A full page of instructions for the leader is included in the *RG* right after the Table of Contents. Each leader should have a copy of these instructions.

Choosing Reviewers: The translation team will ask other believers from their church or community to participate in the review. They can ask 2 to 4 mother-tongue believers who will work with them through all the passages, or they can ask different people to be reviewers for different passages. Ideally, reviewers will speak the gateway language as well as their own language.

Reviewers should not have any prior connection to the Bible translation project. They should be Christians in good standing who have a desire to see the Scriptures translated and accessible to the community.

Prepare for the Review: Once a leader has been selected and at least two reviewers have agreed to participate, they should plan a time to gather for a review session. The leader will need to find a place to meet and prepare these materials:

- One printed copy of the *Reviewers' Guide*
- Printed, translated Scripture for the leader and each reviewer (3-5 copies)
- Access to the gateway language Scripture
- Pen and paper



The leader should take the time to look at the translated passage and the *Reviewers' Guide* questions, to prepare in case any questions need to be adjusted or reworded.

Use slides or a printed page of the *RG* to practice a review of Matthew 3:13–17. Explain each step, and lead a “review” as if you are the leader and the audience are the reviewers.

How to Conduct a Review:

The leader should have a gateway language Bible open to the passage to assess answers to the questions. Although suggested answers are given in the *RG*, these are only suggestions. **Scripture in the gateway language is necessary for comparison.**

During the review of a passage, the leader starts by sharing any **background information**.

Demonstrate. Read the “Background” information from the *RG* or slide.

Then the leader **reads the passage aloud in the translated text**. The text should be available for each reviewer to follow along as it is read.

Read Matthew 3:13–17 aloud.



Reviewers' Guide Training

Next, in **Part 1**, the leader asks for a **summary** of what was read.

Say to them, "Tell in your own words what you just read in the passage." Have them summarize the passage.

The leader will listen and mark the box by each item in Part 1 that was included in the reviewers' summary.

Discuss what boxes would be checked after hearing the summary they gave on the passage.

If points are missing, the boxes for those points will be left blank. The leader may also take notes about what the reviewers said.

Next, **Part 2 contains specific questions**. Reviewers should answer in their own words.

- If a specific question was already covered in the summary, the leader may skip it.
- **If a question is answered in an unexpected way, the leader should ask more questions to determine if the text is unclear or confusing**—for example, "Can you show me in the text where it says that?"

Have them answer **the first 4** questions. Ask them to answer only from what they see in the passage. Discuss how their answers compare to what the ***RG*** shows. Discuss what notes they might write about how the answers were given.

Part 2
Answer the following questions from the specified verses.
1. [12-13] When Jesus came to the temple, what did Jesus tell about?
John told Jesus that he wanted to be baptized by Jesus.
2. [12-13] What did Jesus say when the rulers that John showed him came to him?
I am right for them to be baptized by Jesus.
3. [12-13] What did the rulers of the temple say when Jesus came out of the temple?
The rulers of the temple said that Jesus was making a name for himself.
4. [12-13] What did the rulers from Jerusalem say after Jesus came out of the temple?
The rulers said, "This is very foolish. How can you say that?"
5. [12-13] What were you thinking when you heard that?

Part 2 also has some questions about **implied meanings**. This kind of question includes words like **"Why do you think," "How do you think,"** and **"What do you think."** This means the answer is **not** stated explicitly in the text. (Often this is because the Bible uses many word pictures.)

Reviewers should think about the whole passage and answer the best they can. These questions are the only ones that may be answered using information from other passages or from what each reviewer knows from being a Christian.

A possible answer is given for each of the suggested questions. The reviewers' answers may vary, and the leader should still **note anything unexpected** in the answers and should **ask additional questions** as explained earlier.

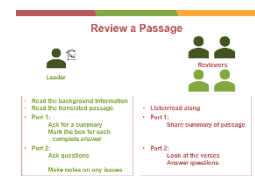
If the reviewers start to spend more than 5 minutes on any implied meaning question, the leader should make a note and move on to the next question.

Have them answer **question 5**. If they immediately answer, "It was God the Father," ask them to explain whether they could understand that from any of the words in the passage.

All through the review session, the leader should make notes about any questions, concerns, or possible errors that are discovered. The leader will keep these notes to share with the translation team.

Summary of Review Session:

- The leader gives the background information.
- Then the leader reads the translated passage. The reviewers listen and read along.
- In Part 1, the leader asks the reviewers to tell back the passage in their own words. The leader marks boxes for the points that were covered.
- In Part 2, the leader asks specific questions. The reviewers look back at the passage and answer the questions, while the leader makes notes.



Reviewers' Guide Training

The leader should understand the following points. (The leader should tell the reviewers the first 4 points from the beginning, and repeat them later, if necessary.) The other points may come up during the review process, and they can be explained then, if needed.

Important Points to Remember:

1. This is a review of the translated text, **not** of the reviewers. No one's knowledge is being tested. (The leader should repeat this point as many times as needed.) The leader should encourage reviewers to give short answers. If they start to discuss other parts of Scripture, the leader should bring them back to the text under review and ask for answers only from the translated text.
2. The reviewers will not be asked to correct or edit anything in the translated text. They only need to respond to the questions based on what is now in the text. If they think something is missing, they may point that out. If unclear passages are found, the leader will make notes and take them back to the translation team for discussion and correction.



Ask: Why do you think the reviewers will not edit the text?

Answer: The translation team is responsible to make the decisions about what needs to be changed.

3. For each question, a verse is specifically referenced. This is to help the reviewers look back at that section and give the response from the text. They should try not to quote directly, but instead say the answers in their own words.
4. Reviewers should answer most questions based on what they read (or hear) in the text.
5. Some questions ask for implied information. These are the "What do you think?" or "Why do you think?" questions. Reviewers will answer these questions using their own knowledge and reasoning, because the answer is not explicitly stated in the text.
6. Some verses have simple questions and can be answered quickly. Other questions are more complex, but a leader should try to move to the next question after about 5 minutes of discussion.
7. The guide does not cover every verse of Scripture. Instead, it covers specific passages. A short background summary will sometimes be given to help orient the reviewers before the questions are asked.
8. The passage should be read (or listened to) in its entirety before any questions are asked. If reviewers can read in their language, they should have a copy of the translated scripture so that they can read along.



Ask: Why do you think that not every verse of Scripture is covered?

Answer: All of the verses have already been checked. This is a spot check that helps the community get involved and that may show problems the translation team did not see.

Exercise: Using the *New Testament Survey Reviewers' Guide*

Preparation: For this exercise, choose a section of the *NT Survey RG* (or, for Old Testament Refinement workshops, use a section of the *OT Survey RG*). Print:

- ✓ the chosen section of the *NT Survey RG*—1 copy for each group of 4 people
- ✓ the Scripture passage you will review in the Source Text—1 copy per 4 people
- ✓ the Scripture passage in the translation you will be testing—1 copy per person.






Key Points

1. Review the translation, not the reviewers
2. No editing here—why?
3. Each question has a verse reference
4. Reviewers answer based on the translation
5. "What do you think?" questions ask for implied information
6. Limit of 5 minutes of discussion per question
7. Not every New Testament passage is reviewed
8. Listen to the whole passage first

Reviewers' Guide Training

NOTE: When training trainers, have the groups practice 3 or 4 review sessions so that each person can have a turn as the “leader.” If you are training in English, two scripture portions in two different English translations are provided. Each person may act as “leader” and repeat the review process with a different passage or translation.

Try it

Instructions:

1. Divide the audience into groups of 3 or 4.
2. Assign one person in each group to the role of “leader.” The others will be “reviewers.”
3. Give each leader the section of the **NT Survey Reviewers' Guide** for the passages to be reviewed, the source text passage, and the translated passage.
4. Give each “reviewer” in the group a copy of the translated passage.
5. Instruct the groups to conduct a practice review of the translated scripture by following the same pattern that you just demonstrated with the large group to. Allow about 20 minutes for the groups to practice. (If allowing each person to take a turn as “leader,” allow additional time for the exercise.)
6. After they have finished, discuss their experiences, what they learned, what was difficult, and if they understand the process better.

 **Ask:** How prepared do you feel to explain this process to the leaders who will use it?

Sharing Feedback: After the review, the leader will schedule a time to meet with the translation team. The leader should go over the notes with the team, and the team will determine what kinds of corrections need to be made. It is best to make sure a typist is also present, with the translation on a laptop. Then the team can go through and make any necessary changes in BTT Writer, and those corrections can be saved. Then the corrected text can be uploaded to WACS.

Confirm:

1. The audience understands that community feedback is necessary before publishing a Bible translation, because feedback can:
 - ☐ Improve quality by revealing places where the translation is not clear or accurate.
 - ☐ Increase community acceptance of the translated Scriptures.
2. The audience is able to:
 - ☐ Use the **Reviewers' Guide** to lead a community review (demonstrated by Exercise).



Matthew 3:13-17

Background: After Jesus grew up, John the Baptist went into the wilderness and preached that people should stop sinning and be baptized. John also taught that someone more powerful than he would come, and that person would judge people.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Jesus came to the Jordan River to be baptized by John. [3:13]
- ☐ John tried to stop Jesus, but Jesus said it was right for John to baptize him. [3:14-15]
- ☐ After John baptized Jesus, God's Spirit came down like a dove and rested on Jesus. [3:16]
- ☐ A voice from heaven said, "This is my beloved Son. I am very pleased with him." [3:17]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [3:14] When Jesus came to be baptized, what did John tell Jesus?
John told Jesus that he needed to be baptized by Jesus.
2. [3:15] What did Jesus say was the reason that John should baptize him?
It was right for them to fulfill all righteousness.
3. [3:16] What did the Spirit of God do when Jesus came out of the water?
The Spirit of God came down and rested on Jesus.
4. [3:17] What did the voice from heaven say after Jesus came out of the water?
The voice said, "This is my beloved Son. I am very pleased with him."
5. [3:17] Whose voice do you think was speaking?
By saying the voice came out of heaven, the passage shows that it was the voice of God the Father.
6. [3:17] Who do you think God the Father was speaking about in verse 17?
The passage shows that he was speaking about Jesus.

Comment Section:

Passage 1

Matthew 13:44-46

Background: Jesus went and sat down beside the sea. A large crowd gathered around him, and he used parables to teach them about the kingdom of God.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

Jesus said that the kingdom of heaven is like a treasure hidden in a field. [13:44]

Jesus also said that the kingdom of heaven is like a merchant looking for valuable pearls. [13:45-46]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [13:44] How did Jesus describe the kingdom of heaven in verse 44?
It is like a treasure hidden in a field.
2. [13:44] What did the man do when he found the treasure hidden in the field?
The man hid the treasure and sold all his possessions and bought the field.
3. [13:44] Why do you think the man bought the field?
He probably wanted the treasure that was hidden in the field.
4. [13:45] How did Jesus describe the kingdom of heaven in verse 45?
The kingdom of heaven is like a man who was a merchant looking for valuable pearls.
5. [13:46] What did the man do when he found a very valuable pearl?
He went and sold everything that he owned and bought it.
6. [13:44-46] Why do you think the two men in the stories sold everything they possessed?
It appears that they sold everything so they could get enough money to buy the land and the pearl.
7. [13:44-46] What do you think was Jesus' reason for saying that the kingdom of Heaven is like these things?
(Answer may vary.) He seems to have meant that the kingdom of Heaven is more important than anything else.

Comment Section:

Passage 2

Romans 9:30-33

Background: In this section Paul quoted two passages from the prophet Isaiah.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

The Gentiles, who were not pursuing righteousness, attained it by faith. [9:30]

Israel, who pursued a law of righteousness by works and not by faith, did not attain it. [9:31-32]

Israel stumbled over a stone of stumbling and a rock of offense. [9:33]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [9:30] How did the Gentiles, who were not pursuing righteousness, attain it?
The Gentiles attained it by faith.
2. [9:31] What did the people of Israel pursue?
They pursued the law in order to become righteous.
3. [9:32] Why did the law not make them righteous?
The law did not make them righteous because they pursued it by works and not by faith.
4. [9:32] Over what did the Israelites stumble?
The Israelites stumbled over the stumbling stone.
5. [9:33] When Paul writes about the stone of stumbling and the rock of offense, what do you think he means?
(Answer may vary.) From this verse, it seems clear that Jesus Christ is called the stone of stumbling, because those who believe in Jesus will not be ashamed. (See also Romans 10:9-11.) The rock of offense has a similar meaning. So this would mean that Jesus Christ was seen as an obstacle and an offense to the Israelites who wanted righteousness by works and not by faith.
6. [9:33] What happens to those who believe in the one called the stone of stumbling?
Those who believe in the one called the stone of stumbling will not be ashamed.

Comment Section:

Passage 1

Matthew 13:44-46 ULB

⁴⁴ "The kingdom of heaven is like a treasure hidden in a field. A man found it and hid it. In his joy he goes, sells everything he possesses, and buys that field. ⁴⁵ Again, the kingdom of heaven is like a man who is a merchant looking for valuable pearls. ⁴⁶ When he found one very valuable pearl, he went and sold everything that he possessed and bought it.

Passage 2

Romans 9:30-33 ULB

³⁰ What will we say then? That the Gentiles, who were not pursuing righteousness, laid hold of righteousness, the righteousness by faith. ³¹ But Israel, who did pursue a law of righteousness, did not arrive at that law. ³² Why not? Because they did not pursue it by faith, but as if by works. They stumbled over the stone of stumbling, ³³ as it has been written,

"Look, I am laying in Zion a stone of stumbling
and a rock of offense.

He who believes in it will not be ashamed."

Passage 1**Matthew 13:44-46 1599 Geneva Bible**

⁴⁴ Again, the kingdom of heaven is like unto a treasure hid in the field, which when a man hath found, he hideth it, and for joy thereof departeth, and selleth all that he hath, and buyeth that field.

⁴⁵ Again, the kingdom of heaven is like to a merchant man that seeketh good pearls,

⁴⁶ Who having found a pearl of great price, went and sold all that he had and bought it.

Matthew 13:44-46 The Passion Translation (TPT)

⁴⁴“Heaven’s kingdom realm can be illustrated like this:

“A person discovered that there was hidden treasure in a field. Upon finding it, he hid it again. Because of uncovering such treasure, he was overjoyed and sold all that he possessed to buy the entire field just so he could have the treasure.

⁴⁵“Heaven’s kingdom realm is also like a jewel merchant in search of rare pearls. ⁴⁶When he discovered one very precious and exquisite pearl, he immediately gave up all he had in exchange for it.”

Passage 2

Romans 9:30-33 1599 Geneva Bible

³⁰What shall we say then? That the Gentiles which followed not righteousness, have attained unto righteousness, even the righteousness which is of faith.

³¹But Israel which followed the Law of righteousness, could not attain unto the Law of righteousness.

³²Wherefore? Because *they sought it* not by faith, but as *it were* by the works of the Law: for they have stumbled at the stumbling stone,

³³As it is written, Behold, I lay in Zion a stumbling stone, and a rock to make men fall: and everyone that believeth in him, shall not be ashamed.

Romans 9:30-33 The Passion Translation (TPT)

³⁰So then, what does all this mean? Here's the irony: The non-Jewish people, who weren't even pursuing righteousness, were the ones who seized it—a perfect righteousness that is transferred by faith. ³¹Yet Israel, even though pursuing a legal righteousness, did not attain to it. ³²And why was that? Because they did not pursue the path of faith but insisted on pursuing righteousness by works, as if it could be seized another way. They were offended by the means of obtaining it and stumbled over the stumbling stone, ³³just as it is written:

“Be careful! I am setting in Zion a stone
that will cause people to stumble,
a rock of offense that will make them fall,
but believers in him will not experience shame.”